

Loveliest of trees

Text: A. E. Housman, 1896

Music: Pierre de Corbeil, harmonized Richard Redhead, 1853

ORIENTIS PARTIBUS 77.77

The musical score is written for a three-part setting in 3/4 time, featuring treble and bass staves. The key signature has four flats (B-flat, E-flat, A-flat, D-flat). The score is divided into four systems, each with three vocal parts (1, 2, 3) and a common bass line. Chord symbols are placed above the treble staff of each system. The lyrics are written below the staves, with some words hyphenated across measures. The piece concludes with a double bar line.

Chord symbols: D $\flat$, E $\flat$ m, A $\flat$, D $\flat$, D $\flat$, G $\flat$, A $\flat$ sus, A $\flat$, D $\flat$, G $\flat$, E $\flat$ m, F, D $\flat$ /F, Fm, E $\flat$ m, A $\flat$, D $\flat$.

Lyrics:
1 Love - liest of trees, the cher - ry now,
2 Now of my three - score years and ten,
3 And since to look at things in bloom
hung with bloom a - long the bough,
tween - ty will not come a - gain.
fif - ty springs are lit - tle room,
it stands a - bout the wood - land ride
And take from sev'n - ty springs a score,
a - bout the wood - lands I will go,
wear - ing white for Eas - ter - tide.
leav - ing me just fif - ty more.
see the cher - ry hung with snow.